

CSS 430 Operating Systems

Program 3B: Synchronization – Dining Philosophers Problem

1. Purpose

This assignment solves the dining philosophers problem, using the pthread library. You will exercise how to use: pthread_mutex_init/lock/unlock and pthread_cond_init/wait/signal to implement a monitor.

2. Synchronization among Dining Philosophers

Review the textbook section 7.1.3 and figures 7.6-7.7. As explained in the textbook, the semaphore solution to associate each semaphore or lock to a different chopstick creates a deadlock. The best solution is to use a monitor that guarantees each philosopher to pick up both left and right chopsticks simultaneously. An alternative but quite inefficient solution is to let a philosopher hog the entire table so that any other philosophers must wait until s/he is done with eating. While it's easy, it does not allow any concurrency among the philosophers.

In this assignment, we will implement these two solutions with pthreads and empirically compare the performance of their concurrent executions. Find philosophers.cpp under ~css430/prog/3B/. This program includes:

Classes, Threads, and Main Program	Actions
class Table0	Allows each philosopher to pick up and put down her left/right chopsticks without checking their availability. The logic is wrong but runs fastest.
class Table1	Allows each philosopher to lock the entire table before picking up her chopsticks and unlock the table after putting down the chopsticks. The logic is correct but has no concurrency, (i.e., runs slowest). You need to complete this table lock/unlock.
class Table2	Allows each philosopher to pick up and put down her left/right chopsticks through a monitor solution. You need to implement the logic of the textbook figure 7.7 here, using pthread_mutex_init/lock/unlock and pthread_cond_init/wait/signal.
void *philosopher(void *arg)	Run as an independent pthread and performs three eating cycles at a specific table, 0, 1, or 2. Note MEALS = 3.
int main(int argc, char** argv)	Receives 0, 1, or 2 as the 1st argument, which means the table #; launches 5 philosopher threads as passing the table #; waits for their completions; and prints out the elapsed time. Note PHILOSOPHERS = 5.

3. Statement of Work

Task 1: Complete the Table1 class by inserting pthread_mutex_lock/unlock appropriately.

Task 2: Complete the Table2 class using pthread_mutex_init/lock/unlock and pthread_cond_init/wait/signal.

Task 3: Compile and run your a.out as follows:

```
[css430@csslab1 3B]$ g++ -lpthread philosopher.cpp
```

```
[css430@csslab1 3B]$ ./a.out 0
```

```
...
```

```
time = 3001444
```

```
[css430@csslab1 3B]$ ./a.out 1
```

```
...
```

```
time = 15005909
```

```
[css430@csslab1 3B]$ ./a.out 2
```

```
...
```

```
time = 8003182
```

```
[css430@csslab1 3B]$
```

4. What to Turn in

	Materials	Points
1	philosopher.cpp a. Code organization: +2pts • Well organized: 2pts, • Poor comments or bad organization: 1pt, or • No comments and horrible code: 0pts b. Correctness: +13pts • Table1 implemented the table lock and unlock: +5pt and • Table2 implemented the textbook figure 7.7 correctly: +8pts, ○ Correct: 8pts, ○ Incorrect: 4pts, or ○ No implementation: 0pts	15
2	An execution snapshot in txt, jpg, png, or pdf	5

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	• Correct (1 thread at a time with table #1 and 2 threads at a time with table #2): 5pts • Wrong: 3pts, or • No illustrations: 0pts	
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Total 20pts.